United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Japan,

TOKYO.

22

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FJ 10310/36

Dear R.H.,

In the course of the last 24 hours my Netherlands, Indian and French colleagues, in that order, have all been to see me about the Yoshida letter. I gave them a fairly full account of what had passed, but was careful not to make any comment on the United States action beyond recounting the facts.

All my colleagues were intrigued by the date of the letter, and I gave it as my purely personal opinion that agreement to publish it, and even to the text itself, was probably reached much later than the date indicates. One of the theories held here is that the Americans decided on 24th December in order to anti-date Stalin's New Year message. The date is really only important because if the letter was actually agreed when it was dated then Mr. Acheson and Mr. Dulles would have been guilty of withholding its existence from the Secretary of State during their talk in January. I find that very difficult to believe, at any rate in the case of Mr. Acheson.

All my colleagues took a gloomy view, which I share, about the consequences of the letter, both on the general Far Eastern situation and on the Korean Armistice talks. But I will be writing about this separately.

I am sending a copy of this letter to Washington.

Yours ever.

Bill Penney.

R. H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,
Foreign Office.

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